

1 Written assignment template for Chat's courses

2 Version: 1.1 (September 22, 2026)

3 This document demonstrates the `writtenassignmentchat` L^AT_EX class. Here are a few things to keep
4 in mind:

- 5 1. When the info in this file contradicts with the instructions in your assignment sheet, follow the
6 assignment sheet.
- 7 2. **Do not** add your name and student ID in the text. (The assignment is usually printed and graded
8 with a pseudonym.)
- 9 3. Use the writing software that you are fluent with to draft your work (or to collaborate with others,
10 if applicable). In the end, if you struggle with L^AT_EX, you can use the MS Word template in the file
11 `z_fallback_template.docx` instead.
- 12 4. Some assignments may not need title, section, figures, or table. Don't use these features when
13 they are not needed.
- 14 5. If you have suggestions to improve this template, file an issue on the [template Github repository](#)¹.

15 1 Quick start

- 16 1. Add your text content to `0-main.tex`, figures in the folder `figures`, and the bibtex references to
17 the file `a-references.bib`.
- 18 2. When you finish writing, make a word count (see the comment at the beginning of the main file
19 and the section 4 below).

20 2 Files

- 21 • `0-main.tex` - Your writing goes here.
- 22 • `a-references.bib` - Reference entries in the bibtex format.
- 23 • `apalike-doi.bst` - bibliographical entry style.
- 24 • `figures` - The folder where you put images.
- 25 • `instructions.tex` - The source file of the template instruction.
- 26 • `instructions.pdf` - The template instruction.
- 27 • `writtenassignmentchat.cls` - The L^AT_EX class file.
- 28 • `z_fallback_template.docx` - A similar template in MS Word that you can use as a fallback.

29 3 Citations

30 3.1 Citation style

31 We use APA-like citations because the last name of the first author appears in the text. This saves
32 readers' time. (No need to hunt down number in the reference section.) Examples:

- 33 • You can cite parenthetically at the end of a sentence with the `\citep` command (Smith and
34 Doe, 2021).
- 35 • The citation can be a subject of the sentence. It read as if you say to "author and colleague...".
36 Use the `\citet` command for this: Brown et al. (2020) presented some findings.

¹https://github.com/chatchavan/assignment_template/issues

- Be precise with your citations when possible by, e.g., pointing to specific page number or section number. Example `\citep[p. 12]{smith2021}` generates (Smith and Doe, 2021, p. 12).
- Alternatively, you can also a prefix text before parenthetical citation with a command like `\citep[see p. 12 of][]{smith2021}`. This results in (see p. 12 of Smith and Doe, 2021).
- To cite multiple items in one parenthesis, use (Smith and Doe, 2021; Brown et al., 2020). This template does not support citing multiple items with text prefix/suffix.
- Preprints should be pointed out explicitly in the text, e.g., “A preprint by Doe and Mustermann (2024)”

3.2 *Reference section*

Ensure that the reference information is as complete as possible. Whenever available, provide Digital Object Identifier (DOI). The bibliography style is fixed to `apalike` in the class; it does not need to be declared separately in the `.tex` file.

4 Word Count

Immediately before the reference list, the class prints the word count of the body text, excluding references. The value is set in the preamble with `\renewcommand{\wordcountvalue}{N}`. For automatic counting, run `texcount --sum 0-main.tex` and copy the result.

If you use Overleaf, see [how to get the word count from the GUI](#)². If you cannot get the word count to work in the command line, don't spend too much time figuring it out. Just compile your work in PDF, copy-and-paste it to MS Word, and use its word count feature. Then, manually set the word count in the command above.

5 URLs and Hyperlinks

When you include a URL, make it as linked text with the full address repeated in a footnote, so the link is accessible in both digital and printed versions. Use the custom command `\linkedfootnote{url}{text}` to automatically create this. Example: [the L^AT_EX project website](#)³.

6 Elements other than the text

Some assignments are text-only, in that case, this section is not relevant.

6.1 *Figures*

Figure 1 provides an example of a figure. When you use the command `\includegraphics`, it first searches the subfolder `figures`. If you want to change the path, add the like `\graphicspath{{your-path/}}` before `\begin{document}`. We recommend creating figure with exact physical size that it will appear on the page, such that you can just use the command `includegraphics` without any parameter in L^AT_EX. In this way, you can ensure that the original figure has appropriate resolution.

6.2 *Table*

Table in L^AT_EX can be tricky. For assignments, there's no need to spend too much time wrangle with L^AT_EX syntax. Instead, you can create a table in other app (e.g., MS Word), export it to PDF, crop it, and include the table as image like Table 2.

²<https://docs.overleaf.com/writing-and-editing/using-word-count>

³<https://www.latex-project.org>

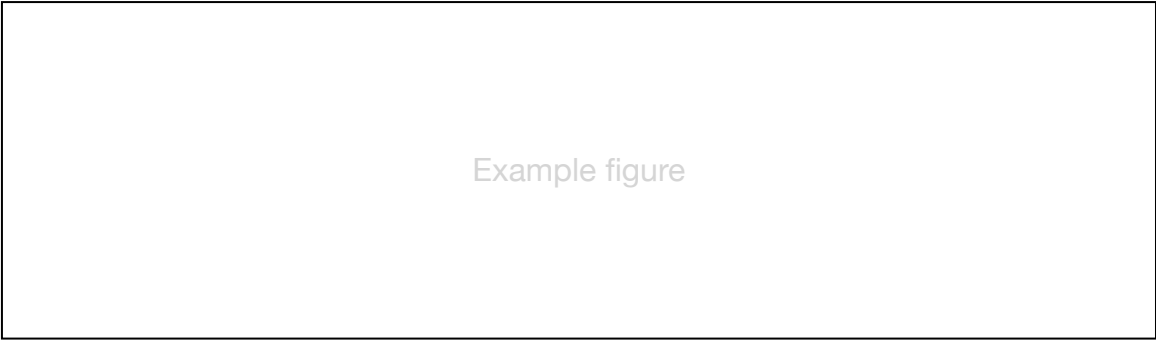


Figure 1: Example figure that spans full width of the document.

Table 1: Example table created in $\text{\LaTeX}$

Element	Setting	Value
Body text	Font family	Helvetica (helvet)
	Font size	11 pt
	Line spacing	1.3 $\times$
Section	Font size	12 pt
	Style	Bold
Subsection	Font size	11 pt
	Style	Italic, underlined

73 **6.3** *Line numbers*

74 Line numbers in the left margin can be disabled by adding the command `\showlinenumbersfalse`
75 before `\begin{document}`.

76 **7 Stylistic specifications**

77 If you use the template, the following settings are already applied. They are documented here for
78 reference purposes.

79 **7.1** *Font style*

80 Body text is set in **Helvetica** at **11 pt** with a line spacing of **1.3** lines. Section headings are **12 pt bold**.
81 Subsection headings are **11 pt italic and underlined**.

82 Do not indent the first paragraph of each section. Do indent subsequent paragraphs. Do not use
83 ligatures.

84 **7.2** *Margins*

85 The page margins are **1 cm top**, **1.5 cm bottom** and **2 cm left and right**. No header is printed; the
86 footer area is included in the bottom margin calculation.

87 **8 Acknowledgement**

88 This template was scaffolded with multiple iterations with Claude Sonnet 4.6, plus a few hours of manual
89 tweaks.

Table 2: Example table imported from a PDF file

Element	Setting	Value
Body text	Font family	Helvetica (helvet)
	Font size	11 pt
	Line spacing	1.3×
Section	Font size	12 pt
	Style	Bold
Subsection	Font size	11 pt
	Style	Italic, underlined

References

Brown, T., Mann, B., Ryder, N., Subbiah, M., Kaplan, J., Dhariwal, P., and Amodei, D. (2020). Language models are few-shot learners. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, 33:1877--1901.

Doe, J. and Mustermann, M. (2024). Preprint of a preprint. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2401.12345*. Preprint – not yet peer-reviewed.

Smith, J. A. and Doe, J. B. (2021). Advances in natural language processing: A survey. *Journal of Artificial Intelligence Research*, 72:1045--1092. [doi:10.1613/jair.1.12345](https://doi.org/10.1613/jair.1.12345).